

Chapter 2: National and Regional Trends and Forecasts

Travel Patterns

Population and employment changes shape both development and travel patterns throughout the region. Understanding these existing patterns provides a basis for developing future transportation needs. Examining trip flows, household vehicle availability, mode share, and forecasted travel demand helps inform decision makers about the investments that are needed to support economic vitality, improve mobility, and enhance quality of life for residents and visitors alike. Figure X illustrates how residents currently travel throughout the region, showing the distribution of trips across different modes of transportation.

Trips by Mode - TBD

Household vehicle availability is one of the biggest determinants of travel behavior and mode choice, shaping whether a trip is made by car, transit, walking, or not at all. **Table 2** presents the distribution of households by vehicle availability and jurisdiction. Vehicle availability is categorized by the number of vehicles available per household, ranging from zero vehicles to three or more vehicles. Because census tracts are the smallest geographic unit for which vehicle availability data are available from the American Community Survey (ACS), estimates for the portions of Chesterfield, Dinwiddie, and Prince George within TCAMPO were calculated using population-weighted spatial interpolation.

As shown below, vehicle availability varies considerably across the region, generally tracking differences in population density and household income. Petersburg has the highest share of zero-vehicle households (14.84%) and the highest combined zero-and-one-vehicle share (63.27%). Hopewell also shows an above-average zero-vehicle share (11.66%). At the other end, Dinwiddie has the highest share of three-plus-vehicle households (46.34%), reflecting its more rural, auto-dependent character, with Prince George and Chesterfield showing similar trends. Overall, TCAMPO (8.20% zero-vehicle) skews slightly higher than Virginia statewide (6.10% zero-vehicle) in low-vehicle-availability households, driven mainly by Petersburg and Hopewell.

Table 2. Household Vehicle Availability by Jurisdiction

Jurisdiction	Households	No Vehicle	1 Vehicle	2 Vehicles	3+ Vehicles
Chesterfield	16,017	4.22%	22.22%	40.93%	32.63%
Dinwiddie	4,409	5.90%	19.37%	28.42%	46.34%
Prince George	10,204	3.47%	22.95%	34.08%	39.50%
Colonial Heights	7,530	6.79%	33.73%	35.96%	23.52%
Hopewell	9,255	11.66%	35.73%	26.12%	26.49%
Petersburg	15,138	14.84%	48.43%	25.84%	10.89%
TCAMPO	62,553	8.20%	31.87%	32.49%	27.45%
Virginia	3,365,732	6.10%	31.13%	37.25%	25.52%

Source: 2024 ACS 5-Year

In addition to household vehicle availability, mode share is determined by other factors including trip purpose and trip distance or travel time. **Figure 17** shows that the majority of workers who are 16 years and over and who did not work from home drove alone to work across all commute durations, accounting for 82% of all commuters and more than 85% of commuters in travel times between 15 minutes to one hour. Walking was most prevalent among the shortest commutes, comprising nearly 24 percent of workers with travel times under 10 minutes, and declining sharply for commutes of 20 minutes or more. Carpooling represented a small but consistent share across all time intervals, ranging from approximately 7 to 11 percent. Transit use was minimal overall but was most notable among the longest commuters, representing about 10 percent of workers with travel times of 60 minutes or more.

Figure 17. Mode Share by Travel Time, TCAMPO Region

Source: 2024 ACS 5-Year Estimates

Changes in Traffic Congestion (2020-2025) - TBD

